

Quarterly Airline Fare & Demand Report

Quarterly Summary

Passenger demand rebounded sharply in 2025 Q2, with total volume climbing to 16.1 million travelers, up 17.3% from the 13.7 million recorded in 2025 Q1. This recovery erased the prior quarter's steep 13.6% decline and returned overall volume to levels consistent with mid-2024, even as average fare slipped 1.9% to \$219.07, indicating the growth in traffic came with modest pricing softness on a revenue-per-passenger basis.

Passenger volume remained concentrated in a small set of transcontinental and hub-to-hub routes. JFK-LAX led all markets with 70,034 passengers, followed by LGA-ORD, JFK-SFO, LAX-SFO, and ATL-LGA, with Delta, United, and American each anchoring multiple top routes through dominant local shares.

Growth was uneven across markets. BWI-MSP, MSP-PDX, and MSP-RDU posted the strongest passenger gains, each more than doubling volume quarter over quarter, all led by Delta. In contrast, FLL-MSP, MSP-RSW, and DTW-RSW suffered the sharpest declines, each falling more than 40%, with Delta again the leading carrier on all three routes, suggesting route-specific softness rather than a carrier-wide issue.

Fare movement diverged from passenger trends in several cases. HNL-SJC, CHS-JFK, and HNL-OAK delivered the strongest fare gains, each up more than 27%, benefiting Southwest, JetBlue, and Hawaiian respectively. On the downside, MSP-RDU, MSY-PHL, and DTW-RDU saw fares fall more than 23%, with Delta and American most exposed among the losers.

Southwest led all carriers in passenger volume at 3.4 million, followed by Delta and American, though Southwest's average fare of \$180.96 trailed the market. Delta posted the strongest combination of volume and premium pricing, averaging \$265.95. At the other end, G4 and XP posted the lowest average fares despite high market share concentration, while carriers ZW, YV, and SY operate with minimal share, indicating limited competitive footprint.

Overall, this quarter reflects a healthy demand recovery after a soft start to the year, though the modest fare decline suggests carriers absorbed some pricing pressure to rebuild volume. Delta's dual strength in both traffic and premium fares stands out as the most balanced performance, while the sharp declines in Minneapolis-linked and Detroit-linked leisure routes warrant closer monitoring going into next quarter.

year	quarter	total_passengers	total_markets	average_fare	fare_per_mile	passenger_growth_pct	fare_change_pct
2024	2	16,321,526.00	35,790.00	219.63	0.24		
2024	3	15,891,856.00	36,890.00	209.21	0.23	-2.63	-4.74
2024	4	15,910,198.00	35,872.00	224.70	0.25	0.12	7.40
2025	1	13,743,520.00	34,658.00	223.29	0.25	-13.62	-0.63
2025	2	16,125,543.00	37,048.00	219.07	0.24	17.33	-1.89

MARKET

Top Markets by Volume

market	passengers	passenger_growth_pct	average_fare	fare_per_mile	fare_change_pct	fare_per_mile_change_pct
JFK-LAX	70,034.00	31.10	458.71	0.19	9.32	9.39
LGA-ORD	61,781.00	46.38	202.43	0.28	19.39	19.32
JFK-SFO	49,269.00	42.67	413.45	0.16	4.23	3.97
LAX-SFO	47,908.00	14.33	126.19	0.37	8.92	8.92
ATL-LGA	43,061.00	26.15	200.28	0.26	13.61	13.15
EWL-LAX	42,309.00	37.59	333.64	0.14	-4.37	-4.32
LGA-MIA	40,905.00	-8.02	207.29	0.19	7.22	6.97
EWL-MCO	40,768.00	-10.80	178.68	0.19	11.63	11.20
EWL-SFO	39,888.00	34.99	440.81	0.17	-11.82	-11.77
MCO-PHL	39,883.00	6.15	156.29	0.18	-1.66	-1.75

Best Passenger Growth

market	passengers	passenger_growth_pct	average_fare	fare_per_mile	fare_change_pct	fare_per_mile_change_pct
BWI-MSP	7,502.00	153.96	179.12	0.19	-20.10	-19.11
MSP-PDX	8,278.00	129.31	206.36	0.14	-17.43	-15.14
MSP-RDU	5,892.00	116.30	208.61	0.21	-25.43	-24.44

Worst Passenger Growth

market	passengers	passenger_growth_pct	average_fare	fare_per_mile	fare_change_pct	fare_per_mile_change_pct
FLL-MSP	5,706.00	-48.92	202.75	0.14	-5.12	-5.37
MSP-RSW	12,919.00	-46.11	184.83	0.13	-17.50	-17.46
DTW-RSW	12,073.00	-42.79	183.11	0.17	-7.34	-7.68

FARE

Best Fare Movement

market	passengers	passenger_growth_pct	average_fare	fare_per_mile	fare_change_pct	fare_per_mile_change_pct
HNL-SJC	6,218.00	-10.53	297.33	0.12	37.68	36.83
CHS-JFK	6,120.00	46.97	205.39	0.32	32.48	32.66
HNL-OAK	5,134.00	-4.89	284.93	0.12	28.06	27.63

Worst Fare Movement

market	passengers	passenger_growth_pct	average_fare	fare_per_mile	fare_change_pct	fare_per_mile_change_pct
MSP-RDU	5,892.00	116.30	208.61	0.21	-25.43	-24.44
MSY-PHL	6,258.00	3.06	235.99	0.21	-24.27	-23.46
DTW-RDU	6,111.00	82.58	183.97	0.35	-23.49	-21.86

CARRIER

Top Carriers by Passengers

carrier	total_passengers	avg_fare	avg_market_share_pct
WN	3,406,160.00	180.96	37.49
DL	2,308,618.00	265.95	21.13
AA	1,979,301.00	251.76	17.47

Bottom Carriers by Passengers

carrier	total_passengers	avg_fare	avg_market_share_pct
4B	1.00	95.69	100.00
AN	1.00	109.88	100.00
AC	3.00	233.83	0.01

Top Carriers by Average Fare

carrier	total_passengers	avg_fare	avg_market_share_pct
99	1,456,678.00	305.91	71.09
UA	1,784,029.00	268.72	14.30
DL	2,308,618.00	265.95	21.13

Bottom Carriers by Average Fare

carrier	total_passengers	avg_fare	avg_market_share_pct
G4	488,178.00	68.22	76.07
XP	68,260.00	85.64	83.24
NK	702,021.00	93.39	10.34

Top Carriers by Market Share

carrier	total_passengers	avg_fare	avg_market_share_pct
XP	68,260.00	85.64	83.24
LF	113.00	151.10	81.61
G4	488,178.00	68.22	76.07

Bottom Carriers by Market Share

carrier	total_passengers	avg_fare	avg_market_share_pct
ZW	162.00	212.27	3.20
YV	56,085.00	260.63	4.56
SY	96,980.00	129.25	5.90